

The AI-Assisted Dataset Journey

From EU legal texts to researcher-adjudicated regulatory relationships

INTERNAL METHODOLOGICAL ACCOUNT

Prepared for the David Levi-Faur regulatory intermediation project

The research problem

Regulatory intermediation is not an actor list; it is a documented relation.

The task was to reconstruct who performs which regulatory function, toward whom, through which mechanism, and where the text supports it.

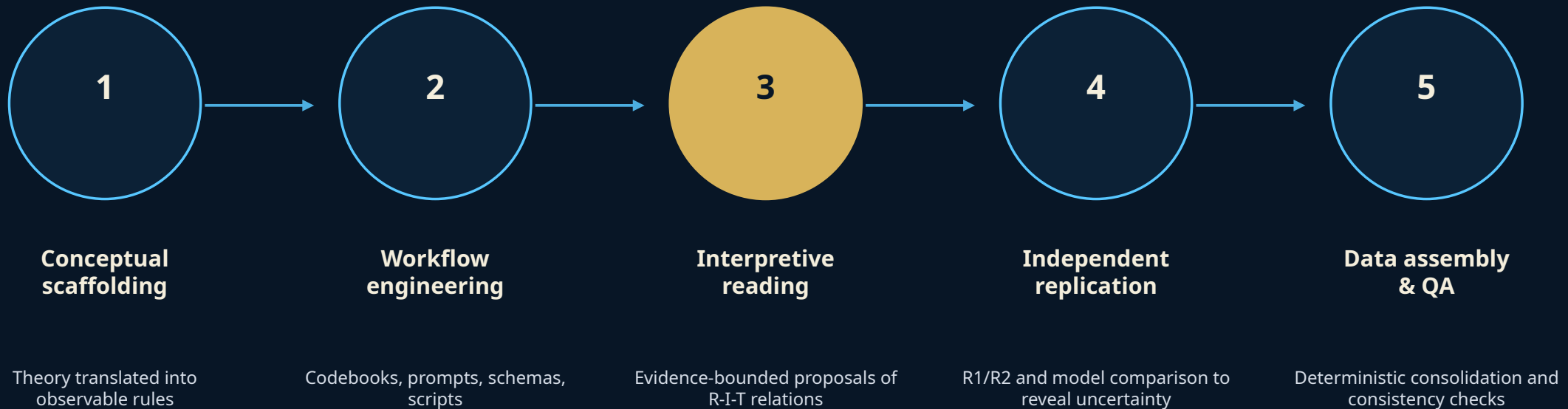


Roles are relational, not permanent attributes.
A single organisation can be R, I, or T in different relationships.

Core rule: keyword hit does not equal regulatory relationship.

How AI entered the project

Not as empirical source; as infrastructure, reader and quality-control aid.



The governing principle was epistemic containment: official legal texts remained the evidence base, while AI outputs remained provisional analytic artefacts.

Early proof-of-concept

The first architecture was useful precisely because it failed productively.

1 Primary coding v1.0

An initial Claude-oriented coder proposed relationships from frozen legal corpora.

2 Secondary review v1.0

A separate Luna-style reviewer tested, revised and challenged the primary outputs.

3 Lessons learned

The main risks were overcoding, actor-object confusion, weak target identification and unsupported inference.

Outcome: these outputs informed calibration, but were not the provenance source of the final dataset.



The experimental branch

G0/G1/G2 was designed to test scaffolding - then deliberately left outside the final production chain.



Purpose: observe whether progressive methodological and substantive guidance improves recall, precision and evidentiary discipline - or causes overcoding.

Historical status: planned and audited, but not executed in the dataset sent to David.

The production turn

The final workflow simplified the architecture around a functional role: Primary Interpretive Reader.

Two independent readings were produced for each case: R1 and R2. Both generated structured, source-bounded proposals: actors, functions, mechanisms, locations and evidence quotes.

Provider recorded: Anthropic.
Exact model checkpoint: intentionally left null
where not self-observable with certainty.

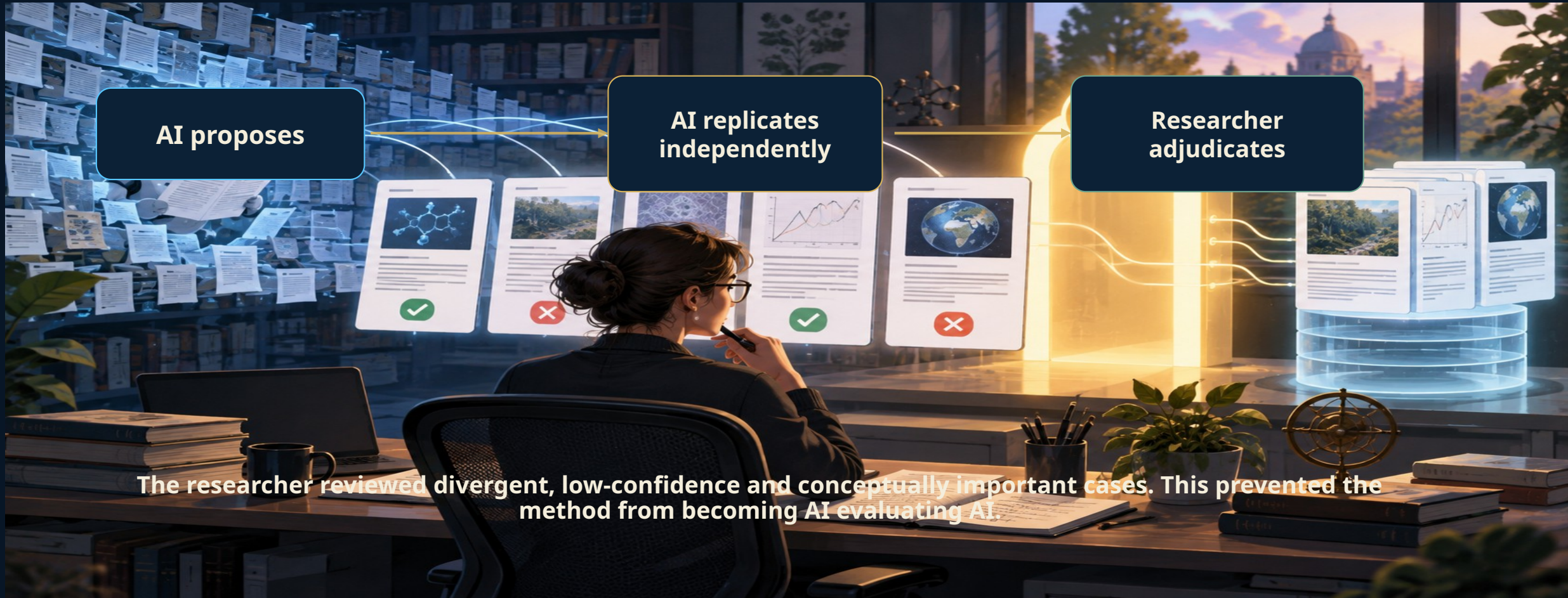
ROLE NAMING OVER BRAND NAMING

This avoided false precision. A documented uncertainty is better science than an invented version number.



Where human authority enters

The decisive move was adjudication, not passive acceptance.



Provenance chain

What is documented behind the package sent to David.



Caveat: the last reduction from 25 review relations to the 20 final episodes is substantively consistent with final cleaning, but no separate script or provenance file was located for that specific jump.

What was sent to David

A deliberately clean research object - not an audit dump.

20
episodes

12
intermediated

8
direct

31
actor-role
records

The workbook contains six tabs: OVERVIEW, ACT_SUMMARY, ACTOR_ROLE_MAP, INTERMEDIARY_MAP, RELATION_EVIDENCE and DATA_DICTIONARY.

It intentionally excludes model/coder/AI columns. Technical traceability remains internal; the delivered file presents functional research categories.

FINAL OBJECT: DATASET + TECHNICAL NOTE

A defensible account of AI use

The cleanest formulation is transparent, limited and epistemically modest.

AI was used as methodological infrastructure, structured interpretive reader and quality-control aid. Model outputs were treated as analytic proposals, bounded by source evidence and submitted to researcher adjudication.

1 Official EU texts remained the primary empirical source.

2 Keyword screening located candidates; substantive reconstruction created relationships.

3 R1/R2 exposed uncertainty rather than concealing it.

4 The final authority over classifications was human.

5 The final workbook was clean by design; provenance is internal.

6 Known documentation gaps should be acknowledged, not disguised.

Bottom line: AI helped build the road; it did not appoint itself judge of the destination.

Suggested oral closing

"This project used AI quite extensively, but not as an autonomous source of truth. It helped me operationalize the theory, structure the pipeline, read the legal materials and detect uncertainty. The final dataset, however, is grounded in official legal texts, explicit evidence and researcher adjudication. The main methodological gain was not speed alone; it was the ability to make interpretation more traceable."



Use this as the narrative core in a meeting: transparent, honest, and scientifically stronger than pretending the machine was invisible.